lover/ The secret of love is in the gallows and rope]'. This affirms a devotion to *shahadat* (martyrdom). In Bismil's poem there is the line, '*aaj phir maqtal meñ qatil kah raha hai baar baar, aa.eñ vo shauq-e-shahadat jin ke jin ke dil meñ hai*' (meaning, 'Today again on the gallows, the executioner is asking again and again / Whosoever has the heartfelt desire for martyrdom so may they step forward').

Indeed, 'from March to October 1928 Bhagat Singh wrote a serial column in the journal *Kirti* titled, "*Azadi ki bhent shahadaten*"' (meaning 'Martyrs for Freedom'). So much so that,

> In the piece about Madan Lal Dhingra (March 1928), Singh writes: 'When pain arose from seeing the chains of slavery grow more powerful day by day, many youths were unable to calm their nation-love-maddened hearts ("*deshprem mein pagal hue di*") with mere speech and proposal-work and some broken-hearted people ("*dil-jale log*") began the revolutionary movement.'[9]

In this way, Sawhney explains, 'Both the emotional charge of love (whether it appears as love for the motherland, love between revolutionaries, love for those who are oppressed, love for the world), as well as the madness of the one who truly experiences this love, are integrally related to the celebration of death.'[10] It is this celebration of death to which we must next turn.